

Assignment 3: Jira & Agile Reflection Questions

1. How did you determine the Epics and User Stories for your project?

I derived the Epics directly from the core modules identified in my Architectural Justification and Requirements Specification. For example, EP-01 corresponds to the Project Submission & Management workflow, which covers the requirements in FR-001. From there, I broke down the broad capabilities into specific User Stories using the standard 'As a [role]...' format, ensuring that each story represented a tangible unit of value for either the student team, the panel judge, or the public voter.

2. What strategy did you use for estimating Story Points?

I used relative estimation with a Fibonacci-style scale (1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13). I assigned the baseline (2 or 3 points) to well-understood, straightforward tasks like verifying a repository URL (US-04). More complex tasks that involved multiple integrations or significant uncertainty, such as implementing the Anti-Sybil automated checks (US-11) and the multi-criteria digital rubric (US-06), were given 8 points to reflect the higher implementation and testing effort required.

3. How did you prioritize the backlog and plan your sprints?

Prioritization was based on dependencies and core functionality. High-priority items that form the foundation of the platform—like submitting projects (US-01) and grading them (US-06)—were scheduled for Sprint 1. Features that build upon this foundation, such as public voting, anti-sybil protections, and the live leaderboard, were placed in Sprint 2. Lower-priority analytics features were left in the backlog for future iterations.

4. What challenges did you face while creating the Jira backlog and how did Agile support this project?

One challenge was deciding whether the anti-sybil checks should be a separate Epic or integrated into Public Voting. I decided to keep them together in EP-03 since they are tightly coupled workflows. The Agile methodology supported this project by allowing me to break down a monolithic 'expo platform' into manageable increments. By focusing Sprint 1 purely on getting projects into the system and evaluated by judges, the team can deliver a minimally viable product (MVP) before tackling the complexities of public voting in Sprint 2.